

Aemann Lin-McCornack

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EDUCATION

Princeton University · Princeton, NJ 2022–present
Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Politics
Dissertation: The Politics of Ruling Alone: Discursive Repertoires and the Contestations of Sole Rulership in Early China and Classical Greece
Fields: Political Theory; History of Political Thought; Comparative Politics; Classical Political Thought; Comparative Political Thought
M.A. in Political Theory, Department of Politics 2024
Reed College · Portland, OR 2018–2022
B.A., Double Major in Classics (Greek, Latin, and Ancient Mediterranean Studies) and Political Science

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Theory; History of Political Thought; Comparative Politics; Classical Greek Political Thought; Early Chinese Political Thought; Comparative Political Thought; History of Autocratic Institutions.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Laurance S. Rockefeller Graduate Prize Fellowship, University Center for Human Values 2025–2026
Phi Beta Kappa, Reed College
Class of '22 Award (*Summa Cum Laude*), Reed College

PUBLICATIONS

Lin-McCornack, Aemann. “Inegalitarian Institutional Design in Late Plato: Synousiai as ‘Festive Gathering’ and ‘Epistemic Colloquium’ in the Minos and the Laws.” *Polis: The Journal for Ancient Greek and Roman Political Thought* 43, no. 2 (2026): 254–284.
Lin-McCornack, Aemann. “Slavery ‘by Disposition’ and ‘by Categoricity’: Revisiting Politics and Nature in Aristotle’s Nature-Based Justifications of Enslavement.” *History of Political Thought* 47, no. 2 (2026): 241–269.

WORKING PAPERS

1. “From Severance to Dependence: Preference Legibility, Bureaucratic Politics, and the *Han Feizi*’s Reconciliation of Rule of Law and Rule of One.”
2. “Of Bounds and Bonds: An Aristotelian Autocratic Typology.”
3. “Laboring Demos and the Birth of the Bastard Son: Intergenerational Trauma, Domestic Abuse, and Political Resentment in Plato’s Populist-Tyrant.”

TEACHING AND RESEARCH

Research Assistant, Princeton University (Prof. Melissa Lane) Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, Princeton University
– International Politics: Human Rights (Prof. Gary Bass) 2025
– Introduction to Political Theory 2024
Mentor for Undergraduate Minor in Values and Public Life, University Center for Human Values 2025–2026
Writing Coach, Department of African American Studies, Princeton University 2023–2024

ACADEMIC CONFERENCES

- “Bureaucracy: Interdisciplinary Perspectives.” The Forum for the History of Political Thought, Princeton University (paper presenter and conference co-organizer). February 2027.
- “Conceptual History of Autocracy.” American Political Science Association (paper author and panel organizer). September 2026.
- “Greek Lawgivers.” American Political Science Association (paper author and panel co-organizer). September 2026.
- “Lest You Linger in this Perpetual State of War: On the Concept of Meionectic Tyranny in Xenophon’s *Hiero*.” Stanford University Graduate Student Conference. February 2026.
- “Lest You Linger in this Perpetual State of War: On the Concept of Meionectic Tyranny in Xenophon’s *Hiero*.” Midwestern Political Science Association (paper author and panel co-organizer). April 2026.
- “The Tyrant as the Medical Doctor: Diagnosis of Institutional Meionexía and Structural Dislocation of Tyranny in Xenophon’s *Hiero* (Hiero 2–8).” Northern Political Science Association (paper author). November 2025.
- “Servitude by Disposition: On Structure and Effect in Aristotle’s Theory of Subjugation (*Pol.* 1252a31–1260b24).” Western Political Science Association (paper author and panel co-organizer). April 2025.
- “Inegalitarian Institutional Design in Late Plato: Synousiai as Festive Gathering and Epistemic Colloquium in the *Minos* and *Laws Book I*.” Midwestern Political Science Association (paper author and panel co-organizer). April 2025.
- “From Tyranny to Kingship: Xenophon’s *Hiero* and its Contribution to the Theory of Anacyclosis.” Southern Political Science Association (paper author and panel organizer). January 2025.
- “Ancient Greek Democracy, Aesthetics, and the Cultivation of the Political.” American Political Science Association (discussant and panel co-organizer). September 2024.
- “Sovereignty and Constitutional Power in Late Plato and Guo Xiang.” American Political Science Association (paper author and panel organizer). September 2024.
- “Socrates and Callicles on Democracy in *Gorgias* 481b6–494a1.” Western Political Science Association (paper author and panel co-organizer). March 2024.

WORKSHOPS AND SEMINARS

- Getting Our Bearings: A Two-Day Gathering to Discuss American Political Developments — Princeton–Humboldt Cooperation “Constitutionalism Under Stress” and The Forum for the History of Political Thought, UCHV (paper presenter). September 2025
- Aristotle in the Americas Workshop, Princeton University (translator and presenter). January 2024
- Classical Philosophy Reading Group, Princeton University (participant). Fall 2022–2024
- Humboldt Berlin Seminar on Academic Freedom. June 2024
- Summer Workshop in Plakias, Crete, Greece. July 2024

SERVICE

Organizer, Social Criticism & Political Thought 2023–2025

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Research Assistant, Prof. Peter Steinberger (Political Theory), Reed College 2022

Teaching Assistant, Prof. Alex Montgomery (International Relations), Reed College Spring 2022

Research Assistant, Prof. Alice Hu (Classics), Reed College Summer 2021

Academic Tutor, Reed College Academic Services 2019–2022

- Introduction to International Relations (POL 240) · Introduction to American Politics (POL 260) · Junior Research Seminar in Political Science (POL 300)

- Ancient Greek, all levels (110/210/311/312) · Russian, first–second year (110/210) · Mandarin, first–second year (110/210/211)

LANGUAGES

Classical (competent): Classical Greek, Classical Chinese

Modern (competent): English, Chinese

In training: Japanese (JLPT N3), German (B1/B2)

Reading knowledge: Academic German (Princeton Certificate of Reading Knowledge, 2024); Latin (advanced, with dictionary)